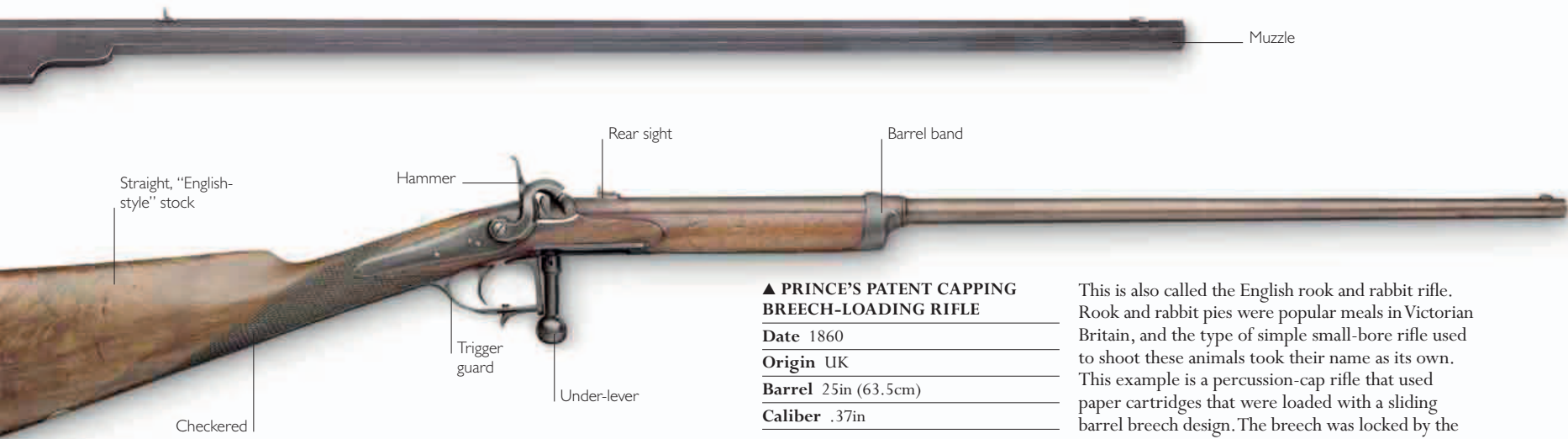




▲ PRINCE'S PATENT CAPPING BREECH-LOADING RIFLE

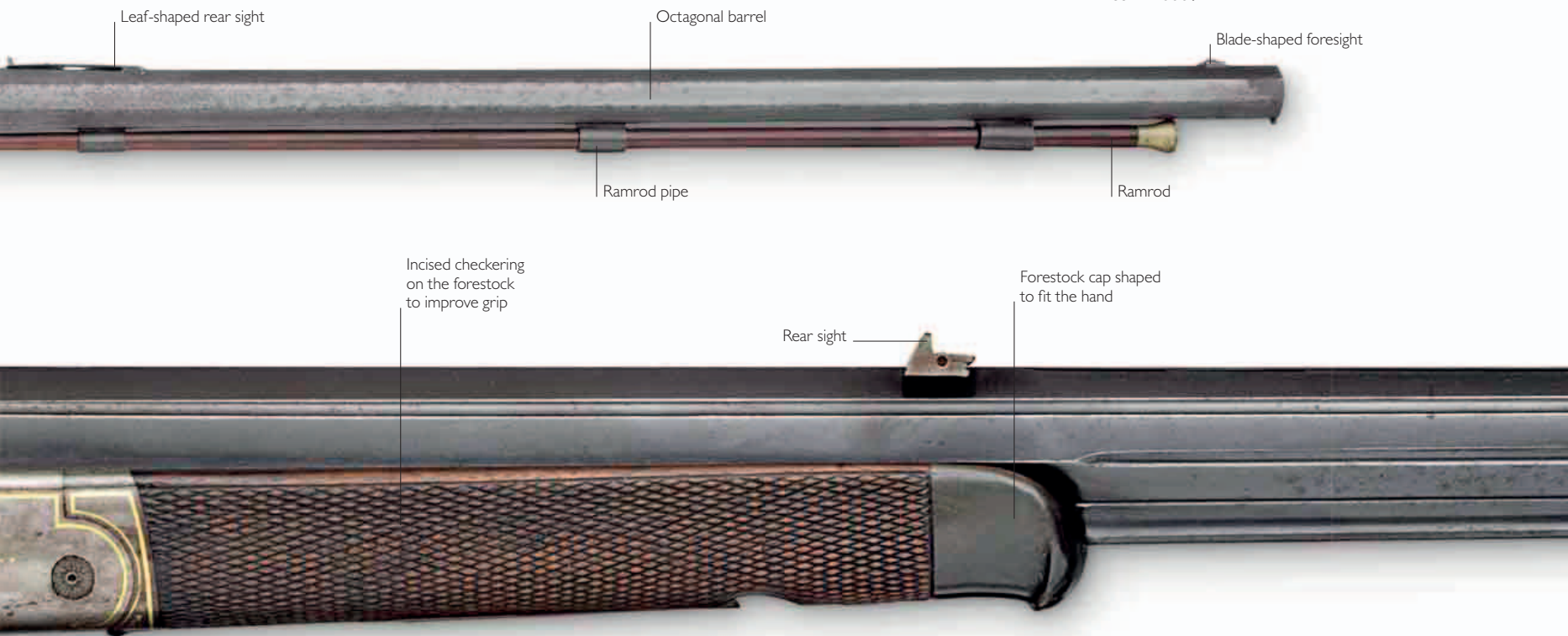
Date 1860

Origin UK

Barrel 25in (63.5cm)

Caliber .37in

This is also called the English rook and rabbit rifle. Rook and rabbit pies were popular meals in Victorian Britain, and the type of simple small-bore rifle used to shoot these animals took their name as its own. This example is a percussion-cap rifle that used paper cartridges that were loaded with a sliding barrel breech design. The breech was locked by the under-lever in front of the trigger guard using a method patented by London gunmaker Frederick Prince in 1855.



▲ GERMAN UNDER-LEVER RIFLE

Date 1880

Origin Germany

Barrel 25½in (63.5cm)

Caliber .45in

Even after the perfection of the bolt-action magazine rifle, there were those who refused to embrace the new technology. Hunters, particularly of big and dangerous game, preferred to trust the simplicity of a break-open design, such as this center-fire rifle.



▲ ENGLISH DOUBLE-BARRELED HAMMER RIFLE

Date 1870s

Origin England

Barrel 24in (61cm)

Caliber 10-gauge (.78in/19.81mm)

This fine Holland and Holland rifle has external hammers that were cocked by hand, ornate scroll-work decorating the lock plates, double triggers for quick barrel selection, and a checkered forestock characteristic of many English side-by-side guns. This gun fired center-fire cartridges.